**Claim Flow when Payor is the HOME Plan**

**PX Usage During Process Flow**

PlanConnexion (PX) is a department within BCBSA that all of our Blue Cross/Blue Shield (Blues) customers us to outsource and run the Mainframe based BlueCard® software. PX installs, configures, and maintains all BCBSA Bluecard software on a Hosted Mainframe tenant for our Blues customers. PX builds and runs daily scheduled batch processes in production to receive and process BlueCard transactions (SF, DF, RF). The source of the files processed can be other BCBS plans as well as vendor system such as HealthRules running as BCBS plans.

PX runs a nightly batch process on their mainframe tenant. This process will run SF, DF, RF batch jobs and produce output files from each job stream that will be sent to HealthRules to be consumed into Payor. The transmission method for sending these files is FTPS.

The BlueCard® Claim "Flow" begins when a Member goes to a Provider outside of his HOME plan area. That Provider submits claims for the services to the Provider's Local Plan region, which becomes the HOST Plan for the claim. The HOST Claims Collection Process sends them in the form of an SF to the PX. They are then transferred from the PX to the HOME Plan to be processed.

**How SF Are Loaded when Payor is the Home**

The Download/Load SF step is triggered by a schedule FTPS process, which gets a batch of SF claim submission files from the PX. Using Moveit®, the files are put into a folder on the Connector's server. The Connector's BlueCard channels import the SF files and insert the claims into the Payor environment.

The "Download/Load SF" occurs in early morning hours M-F by “MoveIt script”

If a Blues customer reports that SF and SFADJ files are missing, you can find the files under the below locations (where MoveIt places the files on Connector). When files come in, report files are generated and sent to Blues Customers. They are labeled "*.rpt". In these files, you can see the HCC IDs for claims and number of files (both succeeded and failed).

Server: bcne-con-pr02, bcaz-con-pr02, etc

- Main directory: /home/cprime/bluecard-inbound-home/
- Where completed files and reports are placed: /home/cprime/bluecard-inbound-home/sf/.done/<datedirectory>

- Hold directory: /home/cprime/bluecard-inbound-home/sf/hold

When the claims come into Payor via Connector, Payor does adjudication. Claims the do not auto adjudicate and create DF's are sent to the Claim Review Workbasket.

**APIC3 Usage During Process Flow**

After the SF transaction is consumed into Payor the claim that is created from the SF is adjudicated in Payor. During the adjudication process as each line item in the claim is adjudicated in payor and will build an interface of the line adjudication results and send the data to an application (APIC3) on the PX mainframe. While payor adjudicates the claim, it is interacting real-time thru MQ with the PX mainframe. (This is "real-time", as opposed to the batch-oriented way that SF, DF, and RF are transferred)

Every line item is done individually, and we must make multiple calls to do that. We use MQ to make the calls. "MQ" is a Message Queuing Middleware utility, which allows us to engage PX real-time through an application called APIC3.

When a user is in Payor, and they hit "Preview Results" or "Adjudicate", if there are any MQ issues, or we're not communicating with APIC3, Payor will issue a "99" review trigger exception back to the users.

**How DF Get Processed**

The DF is ultimately created by APIC3 at the end of our processing with them.

On a nightly basis, PX grabs those DF's in a batch and processes them (For BCBSNE, that happens at 6:00 pm.) They send the DF batch out to the HOST plan, but they also send it back to HealthRules (as HOST plan). We consume that DF back into HealthRules and validate that info against the claim in Payor. (That's the download/apply DF process in diagram)

The download of the DF is done in almost the same way as SFs. The only difference is that they are moved to different folders. If the user does not get a DF, it's the exact same triage process as if they didn't get an SF.

Connector servers

- BCBSNE: bcne-con-pr02
- BCBSAZ: bcaz-con-pr02
- Future customer *-con-pr02

Directories

- /home/cprime/bluecard-inbound-home/
    - Completed files and reports: /df/.done/<datedirectory>
    - Hold directory: /df/hold

**How RF Get Processed**

Payor (as "HOME" plan) has at this point already sent the DF to the HOST Plan, so that they can pay the Provider. The HOST plans do pay them first, but they want to get their money back from the HOME plan, so the HOST plan sends the HOME plan an RF.

It comes back through the CFA/PX, and the RF download is done the same way as the SF and the DF: the file sent through FTPS; Moveit consumes it; puts it in the appropriate SF folder, and Connector loads it into Payor. Payor go through validation of the RF, to make sure the dollars are correct. It'll either be good, and we finalized the claim, or, it fails RF validation.

Connector servers

- BCBSNE: bcne-con-pr02
- BCBSAZ: bcaz-con-pr02
- Future *-con-pr02

Directories

- /home/cprime/bluecard-inbound-home/
    - Completed files and reports: /rf/.done/<datedirectory>
    - Hold directory: /rf/hold

**How EOB Get Processed**

After the RF passes validation, the claim in Payor reaches "final" status and can be released for Explanation of Benefits (EOB) processing.  We (HealthRules) are running a Payment Extract, and then a Custom EOB Extract where an "ePub" document is produced and sent to the team in Nebraska.  BCBSNE is producing their own "EOB" from that ePub document.

## BlueCard Changes in the UI for BlueCard Home Processing

### HCC – BlueCard Feature Configuration Settings

New functionality is triggered based on the BlueCard Home and/or BlueCard Host type being enabled in HCC. For example, The claim source (whether the claim is Local/Home/Host is determined by these settings).

### Claim – BlueCard Claim Source

In the Payor UI, a BlueCard claim is identified by claim source of BlueCard Home type

### Claim – BlueCard Home Tab

The BlueCard Home tab includes areas to track the SF, DF and RF details of the claim.

### Claim – BlueCard SCCF Number

In BlueCard® domains, the claim is identified by the "Scuff #" (actually "SCCF" - pronounced "scuff"). By design, we decided not to make their SCCF our HCC_ID. They are separate, and we track both using our External Claim ID and Ext. Cross Ref. Claim ID (like from the EDI support – because they are very similar types of functionality)

### Claim – Submitted Provider Data (Dummy Provider)

"Submitted Provider Data" is a very important concept to understand about our BlueCard implementation. When a claim **SF** (Submit Format) file is submitted, and pulled into Connector/Payor, it does not contain Provider information. Therefore, a "dummy provider" is used internally. The system uses the submitted provider NPI for evaluating all HealthRules Language rules.

In a HOME claim, when we get a claim SF, it contains Member information, but we do not get Provider information in it. Therefore, a "dummy provider" is used internally. There is a step when configuring a BlueCard® customer environment where the dummy provider gets configured for the claims to get linked to, so it will be

done before Support gets involved. Within Payor, implemented features do make decisions differently and also behave differently because we don't have a actual Provider .

**Claim – Adjudication - "n-PASS" Processing**

- There is a concept of "n-PASS" processing, that is not documented.
- Multi-line claims are submitted ("L1", "L2", and "L3" messages via MQ) to BlueExchange and processed one-line-at-a-time, although the whole claim is sent for processing each line, and each line can be sent more than one time... ergo: "n-PASS".

**Claim – Attachments - "L1", "L2", and "L3" Files**

- L1, L2 and L3 calls are an important concept. Below is an example of a claim that has been re-adjudicated several times, and adjusted, and so forth.
- The L3 is technically the one that finalizes the claim.
- In the following slide, the "L1_1_2375" was the first request/response that we got from APIC3.
- The L2 calls are one for each claim line, and if we are re-adjudicating claim in n-Pass, or just previewing, it generates A LOT of L1 and L2.

**Claim – BlueCard Status**

An important change is that we now have for a claim is its "BlueCard Status". These are in addition to the familiar Payor claim's "Status".

There are several BlueCard Statuses exist, like "SF waiting DF", that indicate at what stage the claim is in its processing.

When the claim SF comes in, we go through the APIC3 call exchanges, and if everything is good, we put the claim Status to "Final", and the BlueCard Status to "SF Waiting DF" . As we process incoming DF, and everything is still good, we change the BlueCard Status to "DF Waiting RF". And if the RF comes in and processes ok, we go to "RF Applied". At that point, we finally release the claim for Payment.

It is an important tweak for BlueCard that we don't release a claim for Payment, EOB, etc. until we reach a certain BlueCard status.

**Claim – Audit Log – Tracing Data**

We have tried to put things into the Audit Log to help trace the claim process, and for Nebraska they have it configured for claims to go directly to the Workbench (this is only a temporary situation, until they have more confidence). The APIC3 LX entries will only be present if the debug property is enabled (which should not be done in PROD).

**Claim - Exceptions**

As indicated above, if there is any issue with MQ communications, the claim is immediately put into Review and there is a message on the Exceptions tab indicating what happened.

**Claim - Versioning**

We do "version" the claim at different points in the process, so you can still go back and see what happened previously on the claim. We don't version every Amend to the claim though. As we are doing the SF, DF, RF communications, we are always working on the current version.

Once we get to a point where we're "set", then any adjustment becomes a new version of the claim. In BlueCard-land, their term "adjustment" is "sorta synonymous" with ours.

Also, because version does happen, the relevant transactions can be viewed in the Transaction Manager. So, for example, if a SF/DF/RF comes in for a claim, one of the early issues was locking issues, that had to be researched via the TM and Lock Mgr (They think they've found/fixed these; DW streaming related). Occasionally a NPE creeps in.

**BlueCard Host**

***BCNE & BCAZ are currently live with Host processing***

**Claim Flow when Payor is the HOST Plan**

At a very high level though, the HOST Plan responsibilities are to:

- Service participating providers within its service area
- Determine provider eligibility
- Follow local practice for bundling/unbundling claims
- Code all claims
- Accurately price services based on provider's contractual arrangement
- Flag fraud investigations

**Initial handling of inbound claim**

When claim is initially received by HealthRules Payor, either by paper or through EDI 837, the first thing it will do is compare the submitted prefix with the HCC/Local Plan Profile list (see below), if the prefix is not listed/found, the Plan Profile Service Driver (PPSD) will be invoked to determine whether the claim should be marked as a BlueCard Host claim, or a local claim. That is, whether the claim should be processed through BlueCard to a receiving HOME plan, or whether the claim belongs to a local member.

The PPSD service is accessed via the IBM Message Queuing (MQ) to send the claim information. The PPSD service will then determine whether the claim should be handled as HOST claim. This process happens as a part of the claim consolidation process, and thus should occur before any other operations in the normal claim handling flow. More information on this process can be found in the BlueCard Training Videos page, under session 2.

In the event the claim is identified as being a HOST claim, the member on the claim is added as an 'External member', which is considered a separate object from a regular member in HRP. In order to find these members, a separate search has been created within Payor to find them. These members will all have a 3-letter prefix in their member ID. The HCC configuration has a list of these 3-letter prefix codes which are defined as 'local'. If the prefix code for the member is not in this list, then they are defined as an external member.

**BlueCard Changes in the UI for BlueCard Host Processing**

**HCC – BlueCard Feature Configuration Settings**

New functionality is triggered based on the BlueCard Host type being enabled in HCC. For example, The claim source (whether the claim is Local/Home/Host is determined by these settings).

**BlueCard Status Descriptions**

**BlueCard CodeSets**

- There are many new "BlueCard Code Sets".
- These sets will only ever be defined in BlueCard customer environments
- Code sets all start with "BlueCard" in their names.

These are codes that only apply to BlueCard. So, not included in the normal distribution. Implemented to be version independent, so that later code sets can be used in older versions (backward is not expected to be needed). So, it is also not necessarily released with each BlueCard release either.

BlueCard Code sets all start with "BlueCard". There are 50-60 sets of them.

**BlueCard Home Message Codes**

BlueCard Home claims are submitted to HealthRules Payor in the BCBS proprietary SF format. These claims can contain special SF Message Codes. SF Message Codes can be used for a variety of reasons in the BlueCard program. SF Message Codes can be informational, conditional, or actionable, and may represent a claim scenario where manual intervention is required on the claim.

As an example, SF Message Code “1040” represents a situation where a Care Coordination Fee is billed on the SF. In this situation it is required that a specific DF MSG code be passed to APIC3 and DF from HealthRules Payor so to identify the care coordination claim and ensure that the Administration Expense Allowance (AEA) is calculated at zero. If all lines on a claim have the SF Message Code “1040,” HealthRules Payor will map the DF Message Code “1322” to the claim level as required by the host system. This will cause APIC3 to calculate the AEA as zero on the DF.

SF Message codes, Informational SF Message Codes, BDC SF Message Codes, and Other Carrier Information Codes returned from the BlueCard Host submitter of the Home claim may indicate that an action needs to take place on the

claim or claim line, like denying the claim, or sending the claim to review using validation policies and benefit configuration.

DF Crosswalk mapping is also done via Codesets. For example: When HealthRules Payor generates the APIC3 call to PX, it translates the HealthRules Payor Code Entry 700 to the mapped DF message code 1166.

**Claim – Input Viewer**

The Claim Input Viewer has a new tab only used for BlueCard claims. It shows all the input fields that map into the supplier invoice. Original values come from the flat SF file. There are a couple hundred fields in the ITS format, many of which are viewable in this tab, including lines. Some of the original data has been translated to first class fields and will instead be visible on the general tab. The SF data on the BlueCard Home tab is the "Consolidated" version of the SF, which could have been modified by HRL, etc. on import – it is important to know that distinction of this tab's data being the Consolidated version when researching problems

**Claim – Amounts Data**

The fields found under the tab are the standard Blue Cross Blue Shield Submission Format (SF), Disposition Format (DF), and Reconciliation Format (RF) fields. These field values cannot be entered manually or edited, unless you have been granted permissions

**SF Information**

**DF Information**

Back on the BlueCard home, in the DF section, there are amounts too. These data are preserved to ensure that things between DF and Payor claim haven't gotten out of sync. (i.e. "Approved to Pay" == our "Allowed Amount")

The DF validation process includes validating the following claim level DF amounts against HealthRules Payor amounts:

- Total amount approved to pay. This DF value must match the sum of the total HCC paid amount, surcharges, and supplemental fees on the HealthRules Payor claim
- Total amount being applied toward the deductible, for which the subscriber is responsible

- Total amount of co-payment dollars, for which the subscriber is responsible
- Total amount of coinsurance dollars, for which the subscriber is responsible

Once the DF information has been received by HealthRules Payor and captured on the claim, the DF information is displayed on the BlueCard Home tab. If the DF validation process is successful, claim status changes to “DF Waiting RF”

If the DF validation process was unsuccessful (that is, if any of the DF/ Payor values above fail to match), the status “Failed Payor DF Validation” is displayed. The specific validations that failed will be displayed in the Header section of the Claim Exceptions tab.
The Processing Results section shows selected data returned with the DF, including Disposition Date, Disposition Code, DF Status Code, HPN Tier Code and other information.

**RF Information**

The RF validation process includes validating the following claim level RF amounts against HealthRules Payor amounts:

- Total amount approved to pay. This RF value must match the sum of the total HCC paid amount, surcharges, and supplemental fees on the HealthRules Payor claim
- Total amount being applied toward the deductible, for which the subscriber is responsible
- Total amount of co-payment dollars, for which the subscriber is responsible
- Total amount of coinsurance dollars, for which the subscriber is responsible

Note the following amount calculations performed during RF validation:

- totalAmountApprovedPayment = HCC paid amount + Supplemental fee + Surcharge fee
- claimLiabilityAmount = HCC paid amount + Access Fee + Supplemental fee + Surcharge fee
- netLiabilityAmount = HCC paid amount + Access Fee + Admin Fee + Supplemental fee + Surcharge fee

Once the RF information has been received by HealthRules Payor, captured on the claim, and validation successfully completed, the claim status changes to “RF Applied.” The RF information is displayed on the BlueCard Home tab. If the RF process was unsuccessful, the status “Failed Payor RF Validation” is displayed.

**Definitions**

- APIC3: Interface on the PlanConnexion Mainframe (PX), used to adjudicate BlueCard claims using MQ messaging
- BCBS: Blue Cross Blue Shield
- BlueCard Claim Source: Field on the claim that tells you how the claim was imported. For BlueCard, this is configured in the HCC settings in Designer.
- BlueCard SCCF Number: BlueCard claim number
- BlueCard Status: Tells you what step the claim is at in the BlueCard lifecycle
- EBCDIC: Extended Binary Coded Decimal Interchange Code is a binary code for alphabetic and numeric characters developed by IBM.
- EOB: Explanation of Benefits
- FTPS: File Transfer Protocol Secure
- Home: Where the member lives
- Host: Where the provider lives
- MoveIt: File transfer service used to transmit SF/DF/RF files between PX and Payor
- MQ: Message Queuing Middleware utility, which allows us to engage PX real-time through an application called APIC3.
- PPSD: Plan Profile Service Driver
- PX (PlanConnexion): BlueCard Mainframe source of truth that hosts the interfaces and processes used by BlueCard claims HOST and HOME plan systems to exchange information used to adjudicate claims and reconcile payments between the plans. PX installs, configures, and maintains all BCBSA BlueCard software on a Hosted Mainframe tenant for BCBSNE/BCBSAZ. PX builds and runs daily scheduled batch processes to receive and process BlueCard transactions (SF, DF, RF).